

Simple user manual

Keep each Mac and GitHub in sync. Use sync for everyday work.

1. Before you start

Run as your normal user, not with sudo. You need Git, Python 3, rsync and working GitHub SSH access. Quit Moom before syncing, and avoid editing managed files while a sync is running or awaiting recovery.

```
macos-config-sync.sh version
macos-config-sync.sh status
```

2. Choose the right starting point

Existing, already-synchronised Mac upgrading from v3.0.x: use adopt once, only if the clean checkout really represents the configuration last deployed to this Mac. It records that baseline without copying files, fetching or pushing. Current edits in HOME are captured by the next sync.

```
macos-config-sync.sh adopt
macos-config-sync.sh sync
```

New Mac: init prepares the checkout without applying it. Back up valuable local settings separately, then use pull only if you intend the repository to replace the Mac's managed configuration. Do not adopt a fresh clone.

```
macos-config-sync.sh init
macos-config-sync.sh pull
```

Warning: pull and restore can overwrite files and delete local-only files inside managed directories. They are recovery commands, not normal ways to sync.

3. Everyday use

```
macos-config-sync.sh sync
```

Run this after changing your configuration and when switching Macs. It captures local changes, reconciles them with GitHub, asks before propagating deletions, then pushes and applies the result. It backs up local files before deployment. The push command is an alias for sync.

If nothing changed, it skips backup, deployment and Moom import. An outstanding NAS mirror is still retried. Timestamp-only differences are not configuration changes.

4. What is managed?

Shared settings include scripts, Git configuration, shell startup files, selected GPG configuration and SSH config. This is not a backup of your whole home folder. Private keys, credentials and caches are excluded.

Brewfile, installed-apps.txt and Moom.plist belong to the matching machine name only. Keep that name stable. Brewfile records packages but syncing does not install them. Run help to see the exact configured paths and overrides.

Files and recovery

Make deliberate changes. If a safety check stops the script, inspect before retrying.

5. Add, stop tracking or delete a file

New files in managed directories stay local unless enrolled. Paths for add and forget are relative to HOME, regardless of your current directory. Use an existing regular file inside a configured scope.

```
macos-config-sync.sh add scripts/example.sh
macos-config-sync.sh sync
```

To keep the local file but remove its repository copy on the next sync:

```
macos-config-sync.sh forget scripts/example.sh
macos-config-sync.sh sync
```

That repository deletion can affect other Macs. To delete a managed file everywhere, remove it locally, run sync and review the deletion prompt. Do not change enrolment while a transaction is pending.

6. If Git reports a conflict

Resolve conflicts inside the private checkout, not the live HOME files. These commands use the default checkout and an example conflict in .zshrc. Substitute the actual conflicted path.

```
repo="$HOME/.local/share/macos-config"
git -C "$repo" status
# Edit the conflicted file: $repo/home/.zshrc
git -C "$repo" add home/.zshrc
git -C "$repo" rebase --continue
macos-config-sync.sh sync
```

Repeat resolution and rebase --continue if more conflicts appear. If you want to abandon the attempt, first save any manual resolution edits you need. Run rebase --abort only if a rebase is active, then cancel:

```
git -C "$repo" rebase --abort
macos-config-sync.sh cancel
```

cancel preserves the pending proposal and resets the private checkout. It never changes HOME, but does not undo commits already pushed or settings already deployed. If HOME changed while a proposal was pending, cancel and start a new sync. Never delete state markers or use adopt to silence a safety warning.

7. Backups and occasional commands

Backups: ~/.local/state/macos-config/backups/

The default keeps 10 snapshots. Copy needed files from a chosen snapshot after inspecting it. restore does not select a backup snapshot.

restore: apply the clean local checkout without fetching. **nas-push:** mirror repository files to the NAS, including deletions. **nas-pull:** advanced recovery into a missing checkout only, inspect it before use. **DRY_RUN=1:** read-only explanation, not a calculated change preview.

If the secret scanner stops a push, review both files and outgoing commit history. Removing a secret only from the latest file does not remove it from earlier commits. Do not bypass the scan.